

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

**COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
ASSISTANT LABOUR, EMPLOYMENT, SKILL DEVELOPMENT &
ENTREPRENEURSHIP OFFICER (ASSISTANT LESO) UNDER LABOUR,
EMPLOYMENT, SKILL DEVELOPMENT & ENTREPRENEURSHIP
DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(APRIL-2026)**

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART-A
(34 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.*

1. Write a précis of the following passage : (14)

Economic inequality is a persistent and growing issue that affects societies worldwide. It refers to the unequal distribution of income, wealth, and opportunities among individuals and groups. While some level of inequality is inevitable in any society, excessive economic disparity can lead to social unrest, reduced economic mobility, and weakened social cohesion. One of the primary drivers of economic inequality is the disparity in education and skills. Individuals with higher levels of education and specialised skills tend to have better job prospects and higher incomes. In contrast, those with limited education and skills often face difficulties in securing well-paying jobs, leading to a widening income gap. This educational inequality is often rooted in socio-economic factors, such as access to quality schools, parental support, and community resources. The labour market also plays a significant role in economic inequality. Technological advancements and globalization have created high-demand, high-paying jobs in certain sectors, while other sectors experience job losses and wage stagnation. This has resulted in a polarized labour market, where a small proportion of workers enjoy significant financial rewards, while many others struggle to make ends meet. Additionally, factors such as gender, race, and ethnicity can further exacerbate labour market inequalities, leading to systemic discrimination and biases. Wealth inequality is another critical aspect of economic disparity. Wealth, which includes assets such as property, investments, and savings, tends to be highly concentrated among a small proportion of the population. This concentration of wealth allows the affluent to generate more income through investments and access better opportunities, perpetuating a cycle of inequality. Conversely, those with little or no wealth have limited financial security and opportunities for upward mobility. Addressing economic inequality requires comprehensive policy interventions. Governments can play a pivotal role by implementing progressive taxation, investing in education and skills development, and promoting social safety nets. Progressive taxation ensures that those with higher incomes contribute a fair share to public resources, while investments in education can help bridge the skills gap and provide equal opportunities for all. Social safety nets, such as unemployment benefits and healthcare, can provide financial security and support for those in need. In conclusion, economic inequality is a

complex and multifaceted issue that poses significant challenges to social and economic stability. By addressing the root causes of inequality and implementing inclusive policies, we can work towards a more equitable society where all individuals have the opportunity to thrive and contribute to economic growth.

2. To maintain 'work-life' balance, there is a surge of people coming on short and budgeted vacations. Seizing this opportunity more people are offering the 'home stay' option. Write a letter to the editor of your local newspaper sharing your views on this trend. (10)
3. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow :

There is absolutely no point in complaining that over the years, there has been pressure for increased productivity and higher earnings for workers in industry. There are several ways for increasing employees earnings. Employee earnings can be increased by raising the selling price of the firm's products and services, reducing profits or costs of raw materials, or augmenting labour productivity. However, increasing employee earning by means other than increased labour productivity jeopardizes the firm's competitive strength in the market. Higher prices usually mean fewer customer, reduced profit means less capital investment, and low-cost material mean poor product quality. But, increasing labour productivity by enhancing skills and motivation creates an almost unlimited resource. The development of economic resources, human as well as nonhuman, is the product of human effort, and the quality of human effort in large part depends on human motivation.

Enthusing employees with workaholic spirit through traditional authority and financial incentives has become increasingly difficult as employees become economically secure and their dependency on any one particular organization decreases. According to expectancy theorists, the motivation to work increases when an employee feels his performance is an instrument for obtaining desired rewards. Nevertheless, in many organization today employees are entitled to organizational rewards just by being employed. Unions, governmental regulations, and the nature of the job itself in some cases prevent management from relating financial rewards to performance. People may be attracted to join and remain in organizations to receive organizational rewards, but being motivated to join an organization is not the same as being motivated to exert effort in an organization. The challenge to management is to find and administer alternative form of incentives which will induce employees to improve work performance. Such alternative forms of reinforcement will require increased understanding of motivational theories and programmes.

- (i) How can organizations derive maximum advantages? (2)
- (ii) State two things that contribute to an increase in employee earnings according to the passage. (2)
- (iii) How do employees feel motivated to work? (2)
- (iv) Pick out the word from the passage means stimulate or influence. (1)
- (v) What factor determines the quality of human efforts? (2)
- (vi) In the context of the passage, a company's competitive strength in the market is affected mainly because of _____. (1)

PART- B
(66 Marks)

*All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.
This Section should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10): Pick out the correct part of speech of each italicized word/words :

1. The Bible is the holy book of the Christians.
(a) Noun (b) Pronoun
(c) Adjective (d) Preposition
2. None of my lost books was found.
(a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Pronoun (d) Verb
3. It was a beautiful sunset.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Conjunction (d) Article
4. He completed his work quickly.
(a) Determiner (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Pronoun
5. I really wanted to go, but it started raining.
(a) Interjection (b) Conjunction
(c) Adjective (d) Noun
6. He was a man fertile in resource.
(a) noun (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) interjection
7. He who is merciful shall meet mercy.
(a) pronoun (b) verb
(c) adverb (d) noun
8. I did not expect to pass, and see, I was among the top five.
(a) noun (b) interjection
(c) adjective (d) adverb
9. Of two evils choose the less.
(a) verb (b) noun
(c) adverb (d) adjective
10. What happened next?
(a) adverb (b) verb
(c) interjection (d) adjective

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 15): Choose the correct preposition from the options provided :

11. I am not interested about anything that happened ____ the very remote past.
(a) with (b) in
(c) on (d) at
12. She made a point ____ coming late so that everyone would look at her.
(a) of (b) at
(c) in (d) about
13. I'm not exactly keen ____ cooking; but I prefer it to washing.
(a) at (b) in
(c) of (d) on
14. Passengers may leave bulky articles under the stairs ____ the conductor's permission.
(a) with (b) by
(c) at (d) for
15. As she was getting _____ the car one of her buttons fell off.
(a) on (b) in
(c) into (d) by

Direction (Question Nos. 16 - 20): Choose the correct conjunction:

16. You will not succeed _____ you work hard.
(a) unless (b) if
(c) because (d) although
17. She acted _____ she knew everything about the matter.
(a) because (b) although
(c) as if (d) unless
18. _____ you apologize, I will not forgive you.
(a) If (b) Unless
(c) Because (d) Although
19. I don't know _____ he will come or not.
(a) whether (b) although
(c) because (d) unless
20. She kept quiet _____ she was angry.
(a) although (b) because
(c) so (d) unless

Direction (Questions 21 – 30) : Complete the blanks using the most appropriate determiner:

21. The book is _____ the table.
(a) under (b) over
(c) in (d) between
22. She walked _____ the room quietly.
(a) on (b) of
(c) across (d) out
23. The picture is hanging _____ the wall.
(a) at (b) on
(c) of (d) for
24. I have been waiting _____ more than two hours.
(a) till (b) some
(c) for (d) to
25. They travelled _____ train.
(a) by (b) in
(c) at (d) to
26. He jumped _____ the river.
(a) at (b) on
(c) by (d) into
27. She is interested _____ dancing.
(a) in (b) at
(c) On (d) to
28. He stood _____ the door wairing.
(a) on (b) in
(c) at (d) for
29. He is afraid _____ the dark.
(a) of (b) at
(c) with (d) to
30. She was born _____ 1960.
(a) at (b) in
(c) on (d) by

Direction (Questions No 31– 38) : Choose the correct vocabulary to complete the sentence:

31. His speech was so _____ that even critics praised his clarity and depth.
(a) verbose (b) eloquent
(c) taciturn (d) ambiguous
32. The scientist's theory was initially met with _____, but later gained acceptance.
(a) scepticism (b) acclaim
(c) enthusiasm (d) compliance
33. She gave a _____ smile, hiding her true disappointment.
(a) radiant (b) benevolent
(c) forced (d) genuine
34. The manager was accused of being _____ favoring only a select group of employees.
(a) impartial (b) biased
(c) neutral (d) objective
35. The child showed _____ curiosity, asking endless questions.
(a) limited (b) indifferent
(c) reluctant (d) insatiable
36. Her success was not due to luck but to her _____ efforts.
(a) sporadic (b) relentless
(c) casual (d) indifferent
37. The lawyer's argument was so _____ that it weakened his entire case.
(a) flawed (b) compelling
(c) persuasive (d) logical
38. His remarks were _____ and offended many people.
(a) considerate (b) insensitive
(c) polite (d) thoughtful

Direction (Questions No 39– 43): Choose the correct meaning of idioms and phrases written in bold letters from the alternative provided below:

39. Although the market is volatile, investors are advised to **keep their powder dry** until the next quarter's results are released.
(a) To panic and sell all assets immediately
(b) To spend all resources instantly
(c) To keep gun powder in a dry place
(d) To remain cautious and ready for action

40. His claim that all politicians are corrupt is **a sweeping statement**.
- (a) Untrue declaration
 - (b) Misunderstanding
 - (c) Overly generalized statement
 - (d) Statement that is proven to be true
41. The need for diversity and inclusion has come **to the fore** in many workplaces.
- (a) Become prominent
 - (b) Be invincible
 - (c) Inconspicuous
 - (d) Ahead of others
42. It is said that he has a **finger in the pie**.
- (a) To have no stake
 - (b) Be involved in something
 - (c) Have wealth and luxury
 - (d) Acquire distinction or glory
43. Growing up in the mountains, I've been surrounded by people who are the **salt of the earth**.
- (a) Sensitive people
 - (b) Good and honest people
 - (c) Hard-working people
 - (d) Simple and carefree people

Direction (Questions No 44– 48) : Identify the correct form of sentences :

44. I have no time that I can waste on idle talk.
- (a) Simple Sentence
 - (b) Compound Sentence
 - (c) Complex Sentence
 - (d) None of these
45. Not many people would be cruel to animals.
- (a) Assertive Sentence
 - (b) Affirmative Sentence
 - (c) Negative Sentence
 - (d) Comparative Sentence
46. Very few cities in India are as rich as Mumbai.
- (a) Comparative Sentence
 - (b) Negative Sentence
 - (c) Affirmative Sentence
 - (d) Positive Sentence
47. Do you not remember her who was formerly your foe?
- (a) Complex Sentence
 - (b) Compound Sentence
 - (c) Simple Sentence
 - (d) None of these
48. There was a great fall, my countrymen.
- (a) Affirmative Sentence
 - (b) Assertive Sentence
 - (c) Positive Sentence
 - (d) Exclamatory Sentence

Direction (Question 49 - 58) : Answer them as instructed:

- 49.** Identify the type of sentence : “ She enjoys reading books every evening.”
(a) Imperative (b) Affirmative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory
- 50.** Choose the sentence that functions as Imperative.
(a) Do you like listening to music ?
(b) What a beautiful flower it is!
(c) Finish your work on time.
(d) He does not play football on Sundays.
- 51.** Identify the underlined phrase : “She spoke in a very soft voice.”
(a) Adjective phrase (b) Adverb phrase
(c) Noun Phrase (d) Verb phrase
- 52.** Identify the underlined phrase : “You could have been told the truth earlier.”
(a) Adverb phrase (b) Noun phrase
(c) Verb phrase (d) Adjective phrase
- 53.** Choose the correct Clause to complete the blank : “He continued working _____ he was completely exhausted.
(a) since (b) even though
(c) as if (d) as long as
- 54.** Which is the correct Clause to complete the sentence ? “The teacher asked me _____.”
(a) where was I going (b) where I go
(c) where I was going (d) where am I going
- 55.** Choose the correct conditional sentence.
(a) If you will work hard, you will succeed.
(b) If you worked hard, you will succeed.
(c) If you work hard, you would succeed.
(d) If you work hard, you will succeed.
- 56.** Pick the correctly structured sentence.
(a) Scarcely had I reached the station when the train had left.
(b) Scarcely I had reached the station when the train left.
(c) Scarcely had I reached the station when the train left.
(d) Scarcely had I reached the station than the train left.
- 57.** Identify the correct sentence.
(a) Each of the students has completed his work.
(b) Each of the students has completed their work.
(c) Each of the students have completed their work.
(d) Each of the students has completed their works.

58. Choose the correct complex sentence.

- (a) He is too tired that he cannot walk.
- (b) He is very tired that he cannot walk.
- (c) He is such tired that he cannot walk.
- (d) He is so tired that he cannot walk.

Direction (Questions No 59– 66): Select from the given alternatives given the one which expresses the same meaning in Direct / Indirect Speech :

59. “Have you anything to tell me, little bird?” asked Ulysses.

- (a) Ulysses asked of the bird if it has anything to tell him.
- (b) Ulysses asked the bird whether it had anything to tell him.
- (c) Ulysses asked the little bird if there is anything to tell him.
- (d) Ulysses asked to the bird whether it has anything to tell him.

60. He said that he did not wish to see any of them and ordered them to go away.

- (a) He said, “I do not wish to see any of them so go away”
- (b) He ordered, “I do not want to see any of you so go away”
- (c) He said, “Go away, I did not wish to see any of you”
- (d) He said, “I do not wish to see any of you; go away.’

61. She said to me, “I have often told you not to mess with me.”

- (a) She reminded me that she had often told me not to mess with her.
- (b) She told me that she has often told me not to mess with her.
- (c) She said that she often reminded me not to mess with her.
- (d) She told me not to mess with her.

62. He replied that he had promised to reward his employees and that he had kept his word.

- (a) He replied, “I promised to reward my employees and I kept word.”
- (b) He replied, “I had promised to reward my employees and had kept my word.”
- (c) He replied, “I promise to reward my employees. I keep my word.”
- (d) He replied, “I have promised to reward my employees. I have kept my word.”

63. She said, “Will you have time to do it?” And I said, “Yes”.

- (a) She asked if I will have time to do it and I replied that I will.
- (b) She asked me if I will have time to do it and I said that I would.
- (c) She asked me if I would have time to do it and I said that I would.
- (d) She asked if I have the time to do it and I said that I will have the time.

64. He said, “I am going to the market.”

- (a) He said that he was going to the market.
- (b) He said that he is going to the market.
- (c) He said that I am going to the market.
- (d) He said that I was going to the market.

65. She asked me why I was late.

- (a) She asked me, “Why I am late?”
- (b) She asked, “Why were you late?”
- (c) She said to me, “Why was I late?”
- (d) She said to me, “Why are you late?”

66. The teacher said, “Honesty is the best policy.”

- (a) The teacher said that honesty is the best policy.
- (b) The teacher said that honesty was the best policy.
- (c) The teacher said honesty had been the best policy.
- (d) The teacher said that honesty will be the best policy.

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